

Excellence Health System

Document Type: ED Provider Note

Patient Name: Jane Smith
MRN: 18273645

DOB: 1958-03-22
Date of Service: 2026-08-08

CHIEF COMPLAINT: Increased cough and difficulty breathing.

HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS:

68-year-old female with severe COPD (GOLD Stage III) presenting with an acute exacerbation. She reports a productive cough with yellow sputum for 4 days. She failed outpatient azithromycin and prednisone started 2 days ago.

PHYSICAL EXAM:

Vitals: BP 142/88, HR 105, RR 30, O2 Sat 85% on room air.
Resp: Diffuse expiratory wheezes, diminished breath sounds bilaterally.
Accessory muscle use observed.

LABORATORY & IMAGING:

ABG: pH 7.32, pCO2 58 mmHg, pO2 55 mmHg (Respiratory Acidosis)
WBC: 14.2 K/uL
CXR: Hyperinflation, no focal consolidation.

ASSESSMENT & PLAN:

Acute exacerbation of COPD with acute hypercapnic respiratory failure.

- Continuous nebulizer treatments.
- Start IV Methylprednisolone.
- BiPAP if respiratory status worsens.
- Admit to intermediate care / step-down unit.